

“Risk minimisation while dealing with open source and cloud software is our main goal”

UK-headquartered Source Code Control Limited provides services ranging from open source software risk management to bespoke cloud transformation recommendations. It has just set up an office in India. In an exclusive interaction with **Sreejani Bhattacharyya and Niraj Sahay** of *Open Source For You*, **Martin Callinan**, founder and director of *Source Code Control*, talks of how businesses can mitigate the risks that come with creating code, and reflects on the overall state of the open source software landscape.



Martin Callinan, founder and director of Source Code Control Limited

Source Code Control Limited is headquartered in the UK, with offices in the US and Central Europe, and now one in New Delhi too. Companies that develop software for IoT, AI, etc, work with Source Code Control to demonstrate to their customers and partners that their software is less risky.

Modern software uses components and libraries that are already developed and available on the Internet, and can be reused. For example, a developer who has a technical challenge can go to GitHub, download the components and fix the problem. But that can bring risk into the application that is being developed.

The risk is two-fold

There is a two-fold risk in developing software. First, there could be vulnerabilities in the code that is being used off the Internet. These could shift to the application and create a risk for the customer, as the software can get hacked. The second risk has got to do with the value of the software company using the code. Associated with any code is copyright law. The code on the Internet will have a licence associated with it, and there are certain obligations that come with that licence. If these are not met, the value of the company using the source code from the Internet can go down.

Source Code Control works with companies to manage this risk. This is such a big problem today that there is now an international standard for how to manage this software supply chain.